Audio and video settings for Teams meetings

Article KB0010072 | Owner: Messaging & Collaboration | Subcategory: Microsoft Teams | Applies to: Windows 11 23H2/24H2 (Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840), macOS 14/15 (MacBook Pro/Air), Microsoft Teams desktop client (latest version from Company Portal), Teams web app, Acme Global Microsoft 365 tenant

Summary

This article provides step-by-step guidance for resolving common Microsoft Teams audio, video, and screen-share problems experienced by Acme Global employees. It includes a user-self-help procedure to clear the Teams cache and reset device settings, a separate service-desk troubleshooting flow, and verification steps to confirm normal operation.

Symptoms

- Teams client fails to launch or stays on a blank screen
- No audio from microphone or speakers during a meeting; others cannot hear you
- Video freezes, shows a black screen, or webcam is not detected
- Screen-share button is greyed out or sharing starts but viewers see a blank screen
- Teams status remains "Away" despite user activity
- Error messages such as "We couldn't start your meeting", "Unable to share your screen", "Microphone not accessible"

Common causes

- Corrupted local Teams cache or outdated client version
- Incorrect audio/video device selection in Teams settings
- Missing macOS screen-recording permission for Teams
- Network restrictions blocking required Teams ports or IP ranges
- Conditional access policies or compliance policies preventing media
- Peripheral drivers outdated or hardware muted/disabled

Quick Checks Before Troubleshooting

Before diving into deeper fixes, verify the basics: ensure the device is connected to the corporate network or VPN, confirm that the microphone, speakers, and webcam are not muted or physically disabled, and check that the Teams client is up to date via the Company Portal. A simple restart of the Teams app often clears transient glitches.

Self-Help Procedure: Clear Teams Cache and Reset Settings

Clearing the Teams cache removes corrupted temporary files that can cause launch failures, audio/video glitches, and screen-share issues. This procedure works on both Windows and macOS clients managed by Intune.

1. Close Microsoft Teams completely (right-click the Teams icon in the system tray or menu bar and choose Quit).
2. On Windows, press Win+R, type %appdata%\Microsoft\Teams, and press Enter. On macOS, open Finder, choose Go -> Go to Folder, enter ~/Library/Application Support/Microsoft/Teams, and click Go.
3. Delete all contents of the folder (you can select all items and press Delete). Do not delete the folder itself.
4. Restart Teams from the Start menu, Launchpad, or Company Portal.
5. Sign in with your Acme credentials and test audio/video in a test meeting or using the Teams test call feature (Settings -> Devices -> Make a test call).

Service-Desk Procedure: Diagnose and Resolve Teams Audio/Video Issues

Agents should follow this flow when a user reports Teams audio, video, or screen-share problems after basic checks have been performed. Collect relevant logs and verify device and policy status before attempting remediation.

1. Ask the user to reproduce the issue in a scheduled test meeting and note any exact error messages.
2. Verify the Teams client version (Settings -> About) and ensure it matches the latest version available in Company Portal; if not, guide the user to update.
3. Check device settings in Teams (Settings -> Devices) to confirm the correct microphone, speaker, and camera are selected.
4. For macOS users, confirm that screen-recording permission is granted: System Settings -> Privacy & Security -> Screen Recording, ensure Microsoft Teams is checked.

5. Collect Teams logs: %appdata%\Microsoft\Teams\logs.txt (Windows) or ~/Library/Application Support/Microsoft/Teams/logs.txt (macOS) and review for errors related to media or connectivity.
6. If the cache was not cleared, guide the user through the self-help cache-clear steps above.
7. If problems persist, verify network connectivity to Teams endpoints (e.g., using https://teams.microsoft.com and port 443) and ensure VPN/Gateway is not blocking media ports.
8. Escalate to Identity & Access Management if conditional access or compliance policies are suspected to block media.

Verification: Confirm Audio, Video, and Screen-Share Work

After applying fixes, run a quick validation to ensure the user can participate fully in Teams meetings. Encourage the user to test each modality separately.

1. Join a Teams test meeting (or schedule a brief meeting with a colleague).
2. Use the Devices -> Make a test call feature to verify microphone and speaker functionality; listen for playback of your recorded voice.
3. Enable your webcam and confirm video appears correctly in the meeting preview.
4. Attempt to share your screen or a specific application; verify that participants see the shared content without lag or blank screens.
5. Check that your presence status updates appropriately when you are active or idle.
6. If any issue remains, repeat the relevant troubleshooting steps or engage the service desk for further investigation.

Additional Tips and Known Issues

Certain macOS versions require explicit screen-recording permission for Teams to share windows or desktops; prompting the user after an OS upgrade often resolves sharing failures. Additionally, Teams may show a persistent "Away" status if the device is locked or if a third-party presence integration is interfering; signing out and back in usually corrects this. Keep the Teams client updated monthly via the Company Portal to benefit from bug fixes and security patches.

When to escalate

If the user's audio, video, or screen-share problem persists after completing the self-help cache clear, verifying device permissions, updating the Teams client, and confirming network connectivity, escalate to the Messaging & Collaboration support group. Include the following details in the escalation ticket: Teams client version, exact error messages, screenshots of Settings -> Devices, relevant excerpts from Teams logs, macOS screen-recording permission status (if applicable), and any Conditional Access or compliance policy alerts observed.

Keywords: Teams audio, Teams video, Teams screen share, Teams not loading, Teams status away, clear Teams cache, macOS screen recording permission, Teams update, Teams test call, Teams troubleshooting